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Reopening of Copper Mine At Jordan River Planned

Restoration of the Sunro copper mine at Jordan River to production within five months was forecast today by the man who shut down operations last November.

The mine closed due to financial difficulty after being operated several months by Cerna Copper Mines Ltd., formerly Cowichan Copper Co. Ltd., in which president Oswood G. MacDonald was replaced by Edward C. Dobell, of West Vancouver.

Dobell said today agreement has been reached, and approval given by Vancouver Stock Exchange, for Crownex International Ltd. (formerly Crown Silver) to acquire all the shares in Dison Development Ltd., which holds the lease on Sunro from Cominco Ltd. Crownex will give 2.25 million shares for all Dison's issued shares.

At the same time, shareholders in Cerna are being offered one share in Crownex for each four of Cerna, Dobell said. Cerna, although it retains corporate status, has no assets.

The arrangement includes a $75,000 underwriting to allow for "minor operating changes," Dobell said.

Dobell and Sidney B. Fowlds, of Burnaby, are principals in Dison, which will be the operating company for Crownex. Both are directors of Crownex and Fowlds is president.

FINANCING

Dobell said major financing to put the mine in operating condition will be arranged by Crownex, which has until Oct. 1, 1970 to commence production.

He said $600,000 will be needed, which includes driving a 600-foot drift into the mine's cave zone where an estimated 900,000 tons of ore are in reserve. Trackless mining will be employed, replacing the diesel-rail system now used.

Dobell said about 120 miners and outside workers would be needed, including the development crew.

Mine manager, and a director of Crownex, will be Donald W. Pringle.

Cowichan first leased the Sunro mine in 1961, It produced until Dec. 6, 1963, when flooding closed it down. The mine reopened and operated intermittently until the last shutdown a year ago.

Major Gas Export Bids Hearing Set

OTTAWA (CP) — Applications by five natural gas pipeline companies for licences to export gas in the next two decades or more will be heard by the National Energy Board at a joint hearing here starting Nov. 25, the board announced today.

Two other firms are seeking board approval of pipeline capacity extensions, and these will be heard at the same time, the board said.

520,000,000 cubic feet to the U.S. through Huntington, B.C., under two licences extending to 1989 and 1990.

Westcoast is also seeking authority to add to its pipeline capacity and gas treating plant at Fort Nelson.

Alberta and Southern Gas Co. Ltd. applied for a licence to export up to 1,552,500,000,000 cubic feet through Kingsgate during the period 1970 to 1993, and Alberta Natural Gas Co. is

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